

Due Process on Hold
A queueing framework for measuring and improving access to SNAP benefits

The Operational Due Process Problem: :

Tens of millions of Americans rely on SNAP and other social services, where call centers are the gateway to interviews, recertification, case updates, and application help. When call centers are overloaded, legally required steps are practically impossible.

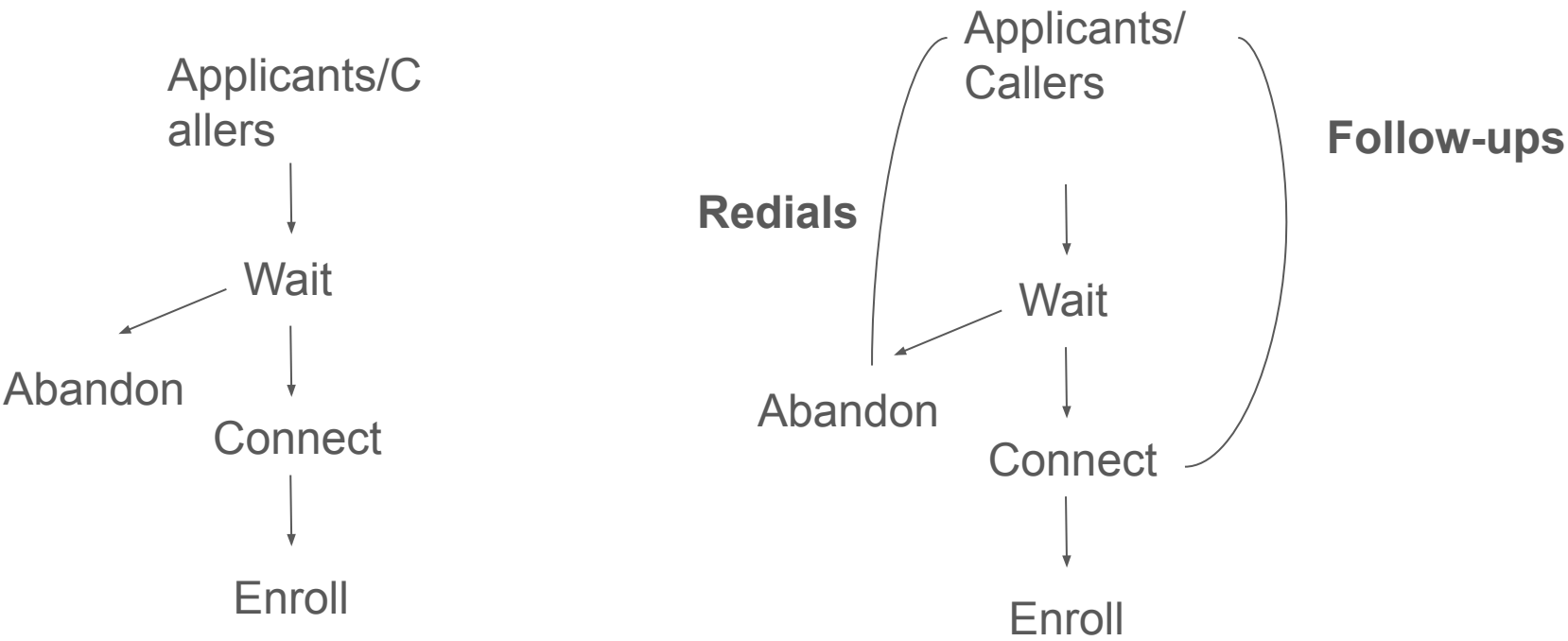
In Missouri, nearly half of SNAP denials were procedural - applicants couldn't complete application steps.

Why current call-center guidance is not enough:

Standard queueing and call-center guidance (Erlang-A) misses the key urgency of social service: callers need to get through, so they'll call back if they can't get through.

We develop a queueing model and performance evaluation framework that includes key SNAP and social service issues:

- Callers who can't get through will call back for essential services
- Even successful callers may need to call back for follow-ups.



Endogenous congestion:
backlog → abandonment → redials → more backlog

What our model can measure
Mean number of waiting callers
Mean waiting time
Abandonment and procedural denial risk
Congestion generated by redials

What can agencies change in our model